11.5.3 Using XML documentation comments to add metadata

One understandable complaint about both the attribute and method approaches for attaching OpenAPI metadata is that the summary and parameter descriptions are divorced from the endpoint handler to which they apply. In this section you'll see how an alternative approach that uses Extensible Markup Language (XML) documentation comments.

Every C# developer user will be used to the handy descriptions about methods and parameters you get in your IDE from IntelliSense. You can add these descriptions to your own methods by using XML documentation comments, for example:

```
/// <summary>
/// Adds one to the provided value and returns it
/// </summary>
/// <param name="value">The value to increment</param>
public int Increment(int value) => value + 1;
```

In your IDE—whether that's Visual Studio, JetBrains Rider, or Visual Studio Code—this description appears when you try to invoke the method. Wouldn't it be nice to use the same syntax to define the summary and parameter descriptions for our OpenAPI endpoints? Well, the good news is that we can!

WARNING The use of XML documentation comments is only partially supported in .NET 7. These comments work only when you have static or instance method endpoint handlers, not lambda methods or local functions. You can find the issue tracking full support for XML comments at https://github.com/dotnet/aspnetcore/issues/39927.

Swashbuckle can use the XML comments you add to your endpoint handlers as the descriptions for your OpenAPI description. When enabled, the .NET SDK generates an XML file containing all your documentation comments.